

RRITA ZEJNULLAHI

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EMPLOYMENT

2023– University of Illinois Chicago
Clinical Assistant Professor of Biostatistics
Division of Epidemiology & Biostatistics, School of Public Health
Joint appointment, College of Applied Health Sciences
Faculty Statistician
Office of Research, College of Applied Health Sciences

2021–2023 University of Washington
Postdoctoral Researcher
Department of Statistics

EDUCATION

2021 Ph.D., Northwestern University, Statistics
2018 M. S., Northwestern University, Statistics
2015 M. A., Eastern Michigan University, Mathematics
2011 B. S., Rochester Institute of Technology

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2024 Award for Best Early Career Research Article for AY 2023–2024, School of Public Health & Institute for Health Research and Policy, University of Illinois Chicago

2020–2021 University Fellowship, Northwestern University

2016–2017 University Fellowship, Northwestern University

2015 Outstanding Mathematics Achievement Award for Excellence in Graduate Studies, Eastern Michigan University (*top departmental award*)

2010–2011 United Nations Children’s Fund (UNICEF) Award for Senior Capstone Project, Rochester Institute of Technology

EDITORIAL ACTIVITIES

2026– Statistical Reviewer, *NEJM Evidence*
2025– Statistical Reviewer, *JAMA Network Open*

2025 Guest Co-editor, with David Banks and Jessica Kunke, of a special issue of *CHANCE* on the Data Science of Refugee Camp Management

GRANT FUNDING

Internal Grants

2025–2026 **Co-Investigator.** *Toward inclusive mobile brain-body imaging for post-stroke gait.* EXITO Pilot Grant, UIC College of Applied Health Sciences. PI: Chang Liu; Co-PI: Lucinda Williamson
Total award: \$50,000

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 Hamstra-Wright, K. L., Gasso, E., **Zejnullahi, R.**, Coumbe-Lilley, J. E. Suicide rates in National Collegiate Athletic Association (NCAA) student-athletes: A 12-year longitudinal analysis. *Journal of American College Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07448481.2026.2636828>
- 2025 Banks, D., Kunke, J., **Zejnullahi, R.** How Can Statisticians Support Refugees? *CHANCE*, 38(4), 6–7.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/09332480.2025.2575727>
- 2025 Lima, N., Jackson, R., Hibner, B., Sherman, S., Fernhall, B., Baynard, T., Crandall, C., Phillips, S., **Zejnullahi, R.**, and Clifford, P. Mechanisms of exercise-induced reduction in peripheral arterial stiffness. *European Journal of Applied Physiology*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00421-025-05821-2>
- 2024 **Zejnullahi, R.**, Hedges, L. V. Robust variance estimation in small meta-analysis with the standardized mean difference. *Research Synthesis Methods*, 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1002/jrsm.1668>
Code and replication materials: [GitHub repository](#)
- 2023 Hedges, L. V., Tipton, E., **Zejnullahi, R.**, Diaz, K. G. Effect sizes in ANCOVA and difference-in-differences designs. *British Journal of Mathematical and Statistical Psychology*, 76(2), 259–282. **(Corresponding Author)**
<https://doi.org/10.1111/bmsp.12296>
Code and replication materials: [GitHub repository](#)
- 2021 Schauer, J. M., Fitzgerald, K. G., Peko-Spicer, S., Whalen, M. C. R., **Zejnullahi, R.**, Hedges, L. V. An evaluation of statistical methods for aggregate patterns of replication failure. *Annals of Applied Statistics*, 15(1), 208–229. <https://doi.org/10.1214/20-AOAS1387>
- 2015 Casey, S. A., Ross, A. M., Groth, R. E., **Zejnullahi, R.** Developing teachers' knowledge for content and students for teaching categorical association. In Bartell, T. G., Bieda, K. N., Putnman, R. T., Bradfield, K., Dominguez,

H. (Eds.), *Proceedings of the thirty-seventh annual meeting of the North American Chapter of the International Group for the Psychology of Mathematics Education*, pp. 872–875.

UNDER REVIEW / WORKING PAPERS

- 2026 Jackson J. J., Hwang I. W., Hurtado A, Bustamante E. E., Quinn L. T., Varady K, **Zejnnullahi R.** & Hibbing P. R. How has the Oura Ring been used in research? A Scoping Review. *JMIR mHealth and uHealth*. Under Review.
- 2025 **Zejnnullahi, R.**, Hedges, L. V. A modified random-effects method for combining effect sizes based on binary data and few studies. Working paper.
- 2025 **Zejnnullahi, R.** Considerations in heterogeneity variance estimation in small meta-analysis. Working paper.

INVITED TALKS

- 2025 Statistical methods for counting refugees during an influx. Invited talk at the Conference on the Data Science of Refugee Camp Management hosted by Duke University. April 2025.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 Suicide rates in National Collegiate Athletic Association (NCAA) student-athletes: A 12-year longitudinal analysis (with Karrie L. Hamstra-Wright, Ellie Gasso and John E. Coumbe-Lilley). Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the American College of Sports Medicine (ACSM). Salt Lake City, UT. May 2026.
- 2024 A modified random-effects method for combining effect sizes based on binary data and few studies (with Larry V. Hedges). Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society for Research Synthesis Methodology (SRSM). Amsterdam, Netherlands. July 2024.
- 2023 Small meta-analysis with the standardized mean difference (with Larry V. Hedges). Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society for Research Synthesis Methodology (SRSM). Paris, France. July 2023.
- 2021 Fixed-effect and random-effects meta-analysis of randomized trials when the outcome is continuous and the number of studies is small (with Larry V. Hedges). Paper presented at the Fall Meeting of the Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE). Washington, DC. September 2021. (Virtual)

- 2018 Prioritizing statistical knowledge for teaching: designing and testing a curriculum module on categorical association (with Stephanie A. Casey, Andrew M. Ross, Jim H. Albert and Randy E. Groth). Presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Mathematical Society (JMM). San Diego, CA. January 2018.
- 2015 Developing teachers' knowledge of content and students for teaching categorical association (with Stephanie A. Casey and Andrew M. Ross). Presented at the North American Chapter of the International Group for the Psychology of Mathematics Education (PME-NA). East Lansing, MI. November 2015.
- 2015 Preparing teachers to teach statistics – pilot study. Presented at the Graduate Research Conference, Eastern Michigan University. Ypsilanti, MI. November 2015.
- 2015 Preparing to teach statistics: Connecting subject matter and pedagogical content knowledge (with Stephanie A. Casey, Joe Champion and Nick Wasserman) Breakout Session at the United States Conference on Teaching Statistics (USCOTS), Pennsylvania State University. State College, PA. May 2015.

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

- 2021–2023 Researcher, Center for Statistics and the Social Sciences (CSSS), University of Washington
- 2019–2021 Member, Statistics for Evidence Based Policy and Practice (STEPP) Center, Northwestern University
- 2019–2021 Graduate Research Assistant, Institute for Policy Research (IPR), Northwestern University
- 2014–2015 Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Mathematics and Statistics, Eastern Michigan University

STATISTICAL CONSULTING

- 2025– Consultant, American Association of Nurse Anesthesiology (AANA)
- 2023– Faculty Statistician, Statistics Clinic, UIC College of Applied Health Sciences
- 2021 Consultant/Facilitator, NSF Summer Research Training Institute on Improving Evaluations of R&D in STEM Education, Northwestern University (Summer 2021)

2018–2019 Consultant/Facilitator, IES Summer Research Training Institute on Cluster Randomized Trials, Northwestern University (Summer 2018, 2019)

STATISTICAL ADVISORY ROLES ON FUNDED GRANTS

2025–2026 **Statistician.** *The Psychophysiological Effects of a Mental Skills Training Program on Injured Athletes: A Feasibility, Acceptability, and Proof of Concept Project.* EXITO Pilot Grant, UIC College of Applied Health Sciences. PI: Karrie Hamstra-Wright; Co-I: John Coumbe-Lilley, Brooks Hibner

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Chicago, Instructor of Record

School of Public Health, Division of Epidemiology and Biostatistics

BSTT 535: Categorical Data Analysis (Spring 2026)

IPHS 402: Analytic and Research Methods in Public Health (Fall 2023, 2024)

IPHS 405: Analytic and Research Methods in Population Health Part II (Spring 2025)

IPHS 454: Quantitative Methods and Analysis I (Fall 2025, 2026)

IPHS 455: Quantitative Methods and Analysis II (Spring 2026)

College of Applied Health Sciences

AHS 511 Biostatistics I (Fall 2023–2026)

AHS 512 Biostatistics II (Spring 2024–2027)

Northwestern University, Teaching Assistant

STAT 301–3 Data Science III (Spring 2020)

STAT 301–2: Data Science II (Winter 2020)

STAT 301–1: Data Science I (Fall 2019)

STAT 383: Probability and Statistics for the Integrated Science Program (Winter 2019)

STAT 210: Introductory Statistics for the Social Sciences (Winter 2018, Spring 2019)

STAT 202: Introduction to Statistics (Fall 2017, Spring 2018, Fall 2019)

Eastern Michigan University, Instructor of Record

STAT 179: Introduction to Statistics (Winter 2016)

MATH 105: College Algebra (Winter 2016)

MATH 107: Plane Trigonometry (Winter 2016)

MATH 110: Mathematical Reasoning (Fall 2015)

MATH 104: Intermediate Algebra (Fall 2014, Winter 2015, Fall 2015)

ADVISING & GRADUATE COMMITTEE SERVICE

UIC School of Public Health

MPH Biostatistics and Integrative Learning Experience Advisor

2026 Haley Elmer; Brooke Wilson

2024 Kelley Bauman; Han Quoc Luu

UIC College of Applied Health Sciences

Dissertation Committee Member

2026 Vered Arbel (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition)

Dissertation Proposal Committee Member

2026 Joy Itodo (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition)

2025 Justin Jackson (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition), Miguel Negrete (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition)

2023 Vered Arbel (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition)

Preliminary Exam Committee Member

2025 Joy Itodo (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition); Justin Jackson (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition)

2024 Miguel Negrete (PhD in Kinesiology and Nutrition)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Professional Development

2024 Inclusive Education Scholar, Center for the Advancement of Teaching Excellence (CATE) and the Office of Diversity, Equity and Engagement (ODEE), University of Illinois Chicago

Service to the Division of Epidemiology and Biostatistics

2024–2026 Advisor, MPH - Biostatistics

Executive Committee Member, Data Science in Health Camp

Admissions Committee Member, MPH - Biostatistics

2024 Co-Organizer, Epidemiology/Biostatistics Seminar Series (Winter 2024)

Service to the UIC School of Public Health

2024–2026 Epidemiology/Biostatistics Representative, Teaching and Learning (T&L) Workgroup

2024 Reviewer, AY 2023–2024 School of Public Health / Institute for Health Research and Policy Research Article Award

2023 Reviewer, Seed Funding

Service to the Profession and Professional Organizations

2022–2023 Judge, Undergraduate Student Project Competition (USPROC), Consortium for the Advancement of Undergraduate Statistics Education (CAUSE) and the American Statistical Association (ASA)

2021–2022 First Round Reviewer, 2022 and 2023 PhD Admissions, Department of Statistics, University of Washington

Volunteer Reviewer, Pre-application Review Service (PARS), Department of Statistics, University of Washington

2019–2021 Speaker Series Coordinator, Women in Statistics (WIST), Northwestern University

Other Professional Service

- 2023 RStudio Mentor, Increasing Statistical Preparation in Research Education for Underrepresented Undergraduates (INSPIRE U2) Program, Spelman College (Summer 2023)
- 2023 RStudio trainer for public case-level datasets from the Cook County State's Attorney, Hacking 4 Justice (H4J)

Ad-hoc Referee Service

Journals: BMC Medical Research Methodology, BMJ Open, JAMA Network Open, NEJM Evidence, Research Synthesis Methods, Scientific Reports

Conferences: Society for Causal Inference

Professional Society Memberships

American Statistical Association (ASA)
Society for Research Synthesis Methodology (SRSM)
Society for Causal Inference (SCI)

REFERENCES

Available upon request